SUNY Old Westbury 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Course Descriptions

Contract All Courses |

History and Philosophy

HI 1010 - World Religions - West

Credits: 4

This course provides an introduction to the three major religions that share a common belief in the God of Abraham: Judaism, Christianity, and Islam. We will look at the history, beliefs, and practices of each religion separately, but also at the ways they have interacted. These interactions-sometimes peaceful and creative; sometimes violent- have been a major shaping force in Western civilization, from the development and transmission of Greek philosophy through the Crusades, the Holocaust and the ongoing definition of "Western values." Study of Judaism, Christianity, and Islam leads to a deepened understanding of principles of theology and ethics, as well as current issues in religious and community life.

HI 1020 - World Religions - East

Credits: 4

It is often said that what is needed in modern life is more "spirituality"-a balance of inward and outward awareness that is often associated with eastern religions. But what do these traditions really mean for people who practice them? This course provides an introduction to the major belief systems and practices of eastern and southern Asia: Hinduism, Buddhism, Confucianism, Taoism, and Shintoism. We will look at the evolution of each of these religions, considering the ways they have inspired individuals and shaped civilizations through cosmology, ritual, literature and art. We will also look at the ways that these traditions influence societies, including our own, that are far from the religions' places of origin.

HI 1240 - Comparative Cultures

Credits: 4

This course will provide the student with a foundation for the study of cultures and current social issues from an anthropological perspective. Readings will include articles and, where appropriate, fiction, concerning such issues as gender, race, and class, as well as the tensions and opportunities facing traditional communities, such as tribal societies, in a changing world.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 2155 - Introduction to Comparative Religion

Credits: 4

Considers the nature and origin of religion, elements of religious practice and thought (symbol, myth, the sacred), ways of being religious, and religion as a basis of community. Methods of analysis include ethical, psychological, sociological, historical, and theological.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 2200 - Science in Western Civilization

Credits: 4

A broad, introductory survey of the development of scientific ideas in the West from ancient times to the 20th century, with an emphasis on the major figures and ideas, and key turning points. The course will present selective social and intellectual contexts of science as well as the role of science in shaping Western thought.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 2250 - Introduction to the Humanities

Credits: 4

What does it mean to be human? What is our place in the scale of being? How have we confronted and how do we now confront the issues of life and death, justice and law, knowledge and truth? This course will deal with these and other basic problems of the human condition, although the particular approach will vary with instructor. Through the close reading of basic texts in the humanities, students will be introduced to some traditional and contemporary approaches to these questions and will have the opportunity to explore and express their own views on these issues.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 2511 - World History I: The Non-Western World

Credits: 4

The first semester of a year long sequence in World History, this course surveys the history and culture of five regions of the world: the Middle East, sub-Saharan Africa, China, India and Japan. Our goal is to gain an understanding of each country's/culture's place in world history both in the past and in the present. To that end we will study maps and regional geographical features, survey crucial historical periods and events and study short selections from religion, philosophy and literature. In the last section of the course, student reports will focus our attention on each civilization's unique contributions to the history of our world.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 2515 - The Making of Asian America

Credits: 4

This introductory course examines the historical context of the existing Asian descendants in the United States through the years since the middle of the 19th century to the present. The issues relating to American immigration policy, race, ethnic identity, gender, and class will be under discussion. It will also analyze the important role of Asian Americans in the building of the country. Documentary films and feature movies will be part of the sources of the study in addition to the regular book readings.

When Offered:

Occasionally

HI 2516 - Special Topics: Asian American Identity

Credits: 4

This course discusses the development of Asian American identity. Asian Americans are diverse population of Asian descents including the Chinese, the Japanese, the Filipinos, the East Indians, and other Asian ethnic groups. Influenced by the Civil Rights Movement initiated by African Americans in the 1960s, Asian Americans forged a unified coalitions calling for self-determination in the multi-cultural society. Discussion topics in the class will provide students the opportunities to explore their own experiences to define themselves in the rapid changing world. This course may be repeated for credit up to two times if the course topic changes and with permission of instructor.

Prerequisites

Permission of instructor if taken as a repeat.

When Offered:

Occasionally

HI 2521 - World History II: Western Civilization

Credits: 4

This course will explore the origins, dynamics and development of Western Civilization. Emphasis will be given to the shaping of political, economic, social, religious, intellectual as well as cultural aspects from the dawn of the West to the Renaissance. In particular, the course will examine the civilizations of the Near East, Egypt, Greece, Rome, Byzantium as well as the making of feudal society and the rise of modernity in the West. Students will understand the heritage of the West and its connection with modern times.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 2681 - Introduction to European History: 1350-Present

Credits: 4

A systematic survey of European political, social, economic, cultural and intellectual history since the Renaissance. The course provides the student with the story of the origins, the pre-conditions, and the continuity of the "making" of the new Europe up to the present. Topics include the age of discovery, nation building, despotism, romanticism, nationalism, science and technology, ideologies and revolutions. An excellent basis for the further study of European history in upper-division courses.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 2700 - Introduction to Logic

Credits: 4

This course is designed to sharpen the student's analytical abilities and powers of reasoning and argumentation. Topics will include types of argument, the structure of argument, how to recognize arguments that are emotionally persuasive but logically fallacious, and the fundamentals of modern, symbolic logic which is the basis for computer languages. The course will stress the practical value of the principles taught and will relate class work to communication skills in general.

Prerequisites

ECII

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 2720 - Introduction to Philosophy

Credits: 4

Serves as an introduction to the role of philosophy in human life. Philosophy will be examined in terms of both its analytical and speculative functions. Of concern will be the relation of philosophical insights to certain compelling contemporary issues. Some of the issues discussed will be the nature of knowledge and truth, the relation of values (both moral and aesthetic) to society, free will, and justice and society. Readings will be drawn from classical and contemporary philosophers.

When Offered:

Every semester.

HI 2810 - Geography, Earth, and People

Credits: 4

Geography sits at the interface between people and their physical world. This course explores this interface by looking at three key elements of the discipline: Mapping, Physical Geography and Socio-Cultural Geography. In the first half of the course, students learn basic concepts and methods to read and make maps and explore the forces making landforms and landscape. In the second half, students make use of these skills and concepts to explore the diversity of human interactions with the physical world. Using the concept of “region,” students are introduced to social and physical factors defining world regions as well as the connections that bind these regions together.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3001 - Introduction to Environmental Studies

Credits: 4

This course will offer students an introduction into the main themes of environmental studies in connection with Old Westbury’s Environmental Studies major and minor. Throughout the course, we will explore and integrate interdisciplinary theories and ideas to guide our study of the environment, particularly as they relate to questions of

sustainability and justice. This class will touch on issues of politics and international relations, economics, history, geography, sociology, public health, law, and ecology. The three units of the class follow the textbook's themes: forces (what causes the natural and human world to operate), grand challenges (why environmental sustainability and justice are difficult to solve), and strategies (how can we understand these complex ideas, advocate for change, and pursue productive habits and policies in our lives).

HI 3002 - Rise of Reason: The Classical Origins of Western Culture

Credits: 4

An introduction to the Greek and Roman origins of Western civilization. This course aims, through a critical study of the works of the greatest minds and literary artists of Greece and Rome, to give an understanding of their contributions to western culture, to provoke thinking on basic problems of human experience, to develop literary taste and judgment, and to improve skills in oral discussion and written analysis. Readings are drawn from the following major genres: epic, tragedy, history and philosophy.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3003 - Environments in World History I: Antiquity to 1500

Credits: 4

The 21st century has brought with it an ever-increasing awareness of environmental concerns and their impact upon our planet. Issues such as climate change, sustainability, food production, land use, intensive farming, pollution and resource use have become part of our global conscience and have formed the center of critical research worldwide. What can we do to alleviate these concerns? Arguably, the past is an important place to begin. An understanding of how past societies managed the land, worked with animals, dealt with varying climates and landscapes and fed their populations may have important implications for the future. This course seeks to provide students with a multi-disciplinary introduction to food, farming and energy in Western Europe from the Roman period through to the late medieval. The course will thus offer an introduction to western history and its developments through the critically important lens of the environment, using a combination of primary and secondary sources. Students will also explore the connections between the west and other parts of the world: interactions between Imperial Rome and the east, the impact of the Vikings from Byzantium to North America, agricultural developments in the Islamic world and late medieval Europeans' interactions with both the western and non-western worlds, particularly in the era of the Black Death. A

variety of sources and source material will be examined, and students will investigate land use, animal husbandry and nutrition through secondary works on animal and human skeletal remains and archaeological studies of Roman villas, medieval settlements and farming equipment.

HI 3005 - Environments in World History II: 1500 to Present

Credits: 4

This course will introduce the evolving mentalities about nature and the environment, which influenced human behavior and actions throughout history from approximately the fifteenth to the twenty-first centuries. It will look at the dual process of how both “natural” and the human-built environment influenced humans as well as how human activities affected the environment. The course explores these themes in the context of an increasingly interconnected world, but with an emphasis on Non-Western examples. The course aims to familiarize students with the fundamentals of studying history as an important basis for developing and improving writing skills, critical thinking, and research abilities

HI 3006 - Environmental Ethics

Credits: 4

This course examines environmental issues from an ethical and philosophical perspective, exploring how different philosophers, religions, and cultures understand the relationship between humans and nature. Beginning with basic concepts in value theory, this course includes a survey of the main positions in environmental ethics: deep ecology, the land ethic, biocentrism, ecocentrism, social ecology, and ecofeminism. In addition to ethical perspectives, this course employs an environmental justice lens to explore how environmental problems intersect with socio-political structures and systems of racial, economic, and gender inequality.

Prerequisites

Writing proficiency: OW Writing 25 or English 1000 grade C or above

When Offered:

Other

HI 3011 - Foundations of the Judeo-Christian Tradition

Credits: 4

Western civilization is often characterized as the dynamic interplay of two cultural traditions referred to in convenient shorthand as “Athens and Jerusalem.” This course will examine “Jerusalem”: the text, figures, themes, and ideas that have defined the Judeo-Christian tradition. The course will emphasize the reading of the Biblical text itself beginning with Genesis and ending with selections from the Pauline tradition.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3021 - Europe in the Middle Ages

Credits: 4

Western values and institutions were formed in the medieval synthesis of Greek philosophy, Roman law, Hebrew/Christian religion, and Germanic folk culture. This course explores the cultural products of that synthesis in art, literature, and religion, and examines the roots of western attitudes toward race, class, nationalism, and war. Taught as social history, it emphasizes the economic and political context in which the cultural foundations of the modern West were forged.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3030 - From God to the Machine: Europe from the Sixteenth to the Eighteenth

Credits: 4

The course will conduct a broad-based examination of the development of the modern mechanistic world-view. Topics will include the Scientific Revolution and Enlightenment, the series of political revolutions that moved Europe from Divine-Right Monarchy to Constitutional Democracy, and the socioeconomic transformations wrought by the Industrial Revolution that moved the mass of Europeans from an animate natural environment to a mechanistic urban milieu, creating the conditions in which reason replaced faith as the common sense of the common man.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3040 - Analysis of Culture

Credits: 4

Exploration of the role of culture in shaping human action and experience. Various approaches to the explanation of culture are considered in the context of the development of social science. Students learn to interpret their own culture and other cultures as systems of knowledge and value. Especially important are the ways culture conditions the effects of social forces in daily life.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3080 - Asian Cultures

Credits: 4

An introduction to the historical and cultural traditions of India, China and Japan. This course invites students to explore the major traditions, ideas, values and social systems that shaped the lives of the peoples of these three Asian countries in the past and that continue to do so today. Students are encouraged to explore their reactions to these unfamiliar ways of life while, at the same time, gaining the ability to view each civilization and culture from its own perspective.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3091 - African Cultures

Credits: 4

An exploration of African civilization, concentrating on the systems of ideas, values, and institutions developed by Sub-Saharan peoples in the context of their historical experience. The unity and diversity of African cultures are related to the economic, political, and social forces operating upon them in relation to the contemporary search for African self-determination.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3102 - Hispanic Heritage

Credits: 4

Taught in English. The Moorish (Muslim) invasion of the Iberian Peninsula in 711 AD, together with the growing presence of Jewish culture and religion in the Iberian Peninsula (Spain and Portugal), transformed the history and culture of the region in ways that are still visible today. Spain's world-view, religion, artistic and intellectual expression, architecture, and most importantly its language, are a result of that cross-cultural evolution that started more than twelve centuries ago. This course will explore the pivotal role played by Spain in modern European history and culture. Topics, such as the Counter Reformation, the Inquisition, the "Golden Age," the "merging of cultures" as a result of Spain's conquest of the New World, and modern Imperialism will be studied and analyzed as part of the Western tradition.

When Offered:

Every fall.

HI 3110 - Latin American Culture

Credits: 4

This history of the Latin American countries is studied from its origins through today. Topics explored include the Amerindian cultures, European conquest and colonialism, African slavery, revolution and independence, "caudillismo" and dictatorships. These topics will be studied through the use of maps, films and literature.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3120 - Latin America: Environment and Society

Credits: 4

This course explores the historical relationships between people and environments in Latin America. Given such a broad approach, the course draws on examples to illustrate diverse human-nature connections in the region and their change across history. Approaches from diverse disciplines in the humanities and social sciences may be used to explore the history and consequences of issues such as environmental degradation, extractive industries, energy use, climate change and urban environments, to name a few. The course highlights the multiple ways in which human societies have interacted with and transformed environments at the same time that these environments have influenced the region's

history, economy, and culture. The course may explore indigenous, colonial, and modern examples, while emphasizing a consideration of enviromental justice issues in the region.

HI 3130 - The Black Church in America

Credits: 4

This course examines the development of the Black Christian Church in its visible and invisible institutional forms during the colonial period, and the merging of these two branches, free and slave, following the Civil War. Also the emergence of Holiness and Pentecostal sects, the impact of urban migrations on black spiritual expression, the Black church and civil rights, gender issues, and the recent challenge of Islam will be dealt with.

HI 3200 - Contemporary Religious Experience

Credits: 4

This course introduces students to the major forms of religious worship and practice in the world today. Videos and field trips as well as readings will be used to develop insights into the distinctive features of worship in various branches of well-defined world religions-Christianity, Islam, Hinduism, and Buddhism-as well as less known or less defined paths such as Sikhism, Rastafarianism, and traditional Caribbean and North American traditions. In addition to exploring distinctions and influences, we will consider the nature of worshippers' experiences of their faiths. At least one semester of academic study of religion is recommended as a prerequisite for this course.

HI 3244 - History of the Arab-Israeli Wars

Credits: 4

This course is an introduction to the Arab-Israeli Wars that shaped the Middle East in the twentieth century. It brings the history of European Jewry into conversation with the British Empire and the modern Arabic Renaissance (*nahda*). We start with the emergence of political Zionism in late-nineteenth century Europe, while at the same time telling the story of nascent nationalisms and radicalisms in the Ottoman Empire with special reference to Palestine. We then spend time discussing Arab and Jewish coexistence and conflict during the first half of the twentieth century, as the Yishuv took shape against the backdrop of British occupation, the rise and fall of the Arab Kingdom of Syria, and Arabic articulations of the struggle against colonialism and neo-colonialism. This brings us to the sequence of wars fought after the

establishment of Israel as a modern nation-state in 1948, 1956, 1967, 1973, and 1982, in addition to the Palestinian intifadas of 1987-93 and 2000-4. Finally, we will discuss the peace process and try to understand why it has stalled today.

Prerequisites

English Comp II

HI 3323 - Buddhism

Credits: 4

This course offers an introduction to the historical, socio-cultural, and philosophical dimensions of Buddhism. It begins with the founding of the religion in India by Gautama Buddha and proceeds to trace its many philosophical trajectories and its multi-cultural history extending throughout Southern and Eastern Asia and beyond. The second half of the semester focuses on the Mahayana Buddhist tradition as a case study in the "attaining of enlightenment" by ordinary individuals, analyzing how this tradition has been shaped by historical and cultural forces as well as how it may apply to contemporary issues in our increasingly globalized world.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 3452 - Women in Medieval Europe, c. 400-c. 1550

Credits: 4

This course is a survey of the history of women, their experiences, and their roles (political, economic, social, religious) in European history from late antiquity through the Middle Ages, including accounts of selected exceptional women, notable and notorious alike, who left their mark on the past. We will look at the ways in which medieval society defined femininity, appropriate female behavior, and the female body, as well as the ways in which those definitions and understandings changed over time. The course explores a wide range of female experiences in the late antique and medieval periods: women and religion; women, marriage, and the household; women in the wider community and finally, women and politics. Students will explore how greatly historians' interpretations of gender relations have changed in recent decades and examine in detail how historical developments affected experiences and perceptions of femininity and masculinity in late antiquity and medieval Europe.

Prerequisites

none**Corequisite** none**Prerequisite/Corequisite**

n/a

When Offered:

Other

HI 3455 - Modern European Revolutions

Credits: 4

A comprehensive analysis of Europe's most dramatic revolutions that have fundamentally transformed modern life. The course will focus the French Revolution, the Revolutions of 1848, the Paris Commune, and the Russian Revolution. The ideological and socio-economic background of each revolution will be examined in the context of Europe's larger cultural, social, and economic development.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 3458 - Frontiers of Science and Technology in the 20th Century

Credits: 4

This course analyzes the role of technology in the 20th Century. An analog world dominated the first half of the twentieth century. It gradually transformed into a digital, connected globe. How did this process of change develop during the Cold War? We will discuss and debate the effects of technology on the Cold War, and you will attempt to determine which technological aspect had the greatest impact on its outcome. This is a course on the history of science and technology as a social phenomenon. This course will cover various technologies, innovations and policies from the United States, the Soviet Union, and their various allies, such as China, in fields such as agriculture, space, communications, among others.

HI 3525 - Ancient Greek Philosophy

Credits: 4

An historical introduction to the foundations of Western thought in Ancient Greece and Alexandria. The course focuses on the philosophies of the pre-Socratics, Plato, Aristotle, the Stoics, the Epicureans, and the Neoplatonists. Readings

include short selections from the corpus of the Platonic dialogues, Aristotle, and Plotinus.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 3558 - Classical Greco-Roman History

Credits: 4

This course will develop an appreciation and understanding of the history of Classical Greek and Roman civilization. It will survey various aspects of society beginning with the early Minoan and Mycenaean civilization and ending with the fall of the Western Roman Empire. The course goals are for students to learn the historical and cultural framework of Greek and Roman civilizations; to understand the social, ethical and religious setting as well as the philosophical thought of the time; to comprehend geographical locations, the names of prominent people in history and their political and military contributions as these influenced both their times and today; to explore the relationship of Greco-Roman civilization to neighboring civilizations to the east and the peoples to the north; and to apply critical and creative thinking to the study of ancient leaders and extrapolate what can be learned from their life experiences.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3600 - Global Geography: People, Places and Environments

Credits: 4

This course is an introduction to the major topics in human geography. It highlights the roots of contemporary global relationships among places as they influence social, political and economic trends. A wide and shifting range of topics are covered including, among others, the political economy of the world system, globalization and development, population, geopolitics, the geography of food and agriculture and urban geography. This course also introduces students to the critical thinking skills necessary for a geographical analysis and to sharpen their global awareness.

When Offered:

Every semester.

HI 3610 - America’s African Heritage

Credits: 4

An examination of the role of Africans in the shaping of America's culture and society up to the present. An interdisciplinary study of the notion of cultural continuity, and of cultural carryovers as they have impacted upon language, music, art forms, religious worship, and political life.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 3630 - Digital Mapping

Credits: 4

An introduction to the theory, techniques and practice of Digital Mapping and Geographic Information Systems (GIS). The course provides the basic elements needed to interpret geographical information, process it and present it in the form of digitally produced maps using applications such as Google Maps, OpenStreetMap, Carto DB and QGIS. The course also provides students with the tools to critically read and interpret maps as powerful sources of information.

HI 3640 - African History

Credits: 4

Approaches the history of Africa from the viewpoint of African people. Archaeological records, oral tradition and documentary sources bring ancient and medieval Africa to life. Later units will focus on important themes and debates in African history today. Students will come to understand African civilization in the context of who Africans are, the social forces that have shaped their experience, and the new directions and problems they face in the post-independence era.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3692 - Modern Asian History

Credits: 4

A survey of the historical, political, economic and social changes that re-shaped the Asian world from the midnineteenth century to the present day, with special emphasis on the countries of China and Japan occasionally.

HI 3700 - Historical Geography of Latin America

Credits: 4

This course is an exploration of the construction of Latin America as a geographical region from colonial times to the present. The course focuses on the economic and cultural processes involved in production the region over time. We also look at how the region has historically been divided into sub-regions and specific countries, placing an emphasis on the political economic forces underlying these division. In addition, the course pays particular attention to the cultural production of Latin American sub-regions with an emphasis on the history of various racial groups in different parts of the region.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3703 - Modern Philosophy

Credits: 4

This course will examine some of the major philosophers of the modern period. Readings will be drawn from thinkers including Descartes, Hume, Kant, Hegel, Marx, Kierkegaard, Nietzsche. The course will conclude with selected topics and issues in 20th Century thought.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 3704 - African Religions and Philosophy

Credits: 4

The view of the African cosmology and religion as a system of thought. Principles of what constitutes African philosophy and religion will be examined to analyze the effects on society and politics. The study includes animism, Christianity and Islam.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 3710 - Contemporary Philosophical Issues

Credits: 4

This course provides a focused analysis of philosophical questions central to contemporary social and political debate. Topics will be drawn from such current issues as climate change, the philosophy of race and gender, the nature of social justice, and other social, cultural, and ecological issues.

Prerequisite/Corequisite

Writing proficiency: OW writing score of 25 or ENG 1000 with C or above.

HI 3752 - Ethics

Credits: 4

What principles should guide my actions? Are moral values relative or absolute? What is the relationship between law and morality? Why should I be moral? This course will examine the answers to these questions in the works of such thinkers as Aristotle, Kant, and Mill. It will apply these traditional ethical views to contemporary issues such as the environment, social justice, abortion, euthanasia, and racial and sexual discrimination.

Prerequisites

Writing proficiency. OW score of 25 or ENG 1000 C or above

HI 3835 - Islamic Cultures

Credits: 4

This course provides an introduction to the history of Muslim people and societies, and the belief system of Islam. Beginning with the socio-economic background of pre-Islamic Arabia, we will explore the radically transforming message of the Quran and the empire founded by Muhammad as spiritual and political leader. Students will gain insight into the spread of Islam, as it developed from a regional faith into a force in world civilization in Europe, Africa, the Middle East, and Asia.

HI 3840 - Crescent and Cross: Islam and Christianity in History

Credits: 4

This course provides an introduction to the roles that Islam and Christianity have played in the history and social structures of the Middle East and Europe. After presentation of the origins and essential principles of both faiths, we will explore the interactions of the faith communities across geographic and ideological boundaries, concluding with consideration of how Muslim/ Christian dialogue and conflict shape our world today.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 3950 - Philosophy of Religion

Credits: 4

The course is an examination of religion and the logic of religious discourse. It explores formal, philosophical, and mystical types of theologies; epistemological ethics of revelation, sin, guilt, faith, and salvation; the concept of and arguments for the existence of God; paradigms of experiential religion, such as the encounter of the human being with the divine in Judaism, the experience of love in Christianity, the surrender as de-alienation in the Islamic Sufi vision, and the dialectics of dynamic interdependence expressed as yin-yang in Daoism. A consideration of psychological accounts of religion, challenges of naturalism, existential atheism, and philosophical analysis.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 4001 - Nineteenth Century

Credits: 4

The impact of European culture and imperialism on the peoples of India and Japan. Literary works of the period are used to highlight the changes reshaping Europe in the early nineteenth century, the encounters between Europeans and Asian peoples which accompanied the expansion of Europe and the attempts of Europeans and Asians to come to terms with these encounters. Readings include Dickens' Hard Times, stories by Rudyard Kipling and Rabindranath Tagore, Botchan by Natsume Soseki.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 4011 - Twentieth Century

Credits: 4

The mutual impact of cultures throughout the world; the end of nineteenth century colonialism; revolutions and wars; the emergence of the "third world." Study of the interrelationship of European with Asian and African cultures in the twentieth century. Readings include novels from several cultures.

When Offered:

Each spring.

HI 4015 - Gender, Sex, and Power in China

Credits: 4

This course interrogates categories of gender, sex, and power in China. From the legacy of Confucian gender ideology in the 4th Century BCE to the invention of "New Womanhood/Manhood" and the rise of feminism in the 20th and 21st centuries, we will read seminal scholarship in the form of articles, book chapters, theory, memoir, and literature to examine the ways concepts of gender and sex impacted and shaped peoples' lived experiences and life choices. We will grapple with themes of patriarchy/ies, sexuality, ethnicity, class, marriage, family, law, work, body, and medicine as we explore how forms of resistance, agency, and identity formation were developed and shaped in encounter with competing ideologies and intercultural exchange. We will grapple with the following questions: are "gender" and "sex" useful categories of analysis for writing history? What is the relationship between gender and sex and empire/nation building? In what ways did people of varied sexual orientations and gender expressions maneuver and create meaning in their lives despite the constraints of unequal gender/sex systems? How did they resist? The course pays particular attention to the methodological difficulty of reconstructing women and gender non-conforming individuals from a largely male-produced/male-audience archive and considers strategies to surmount these obstacles in the writing of

history.

Prerequisites

None**Corequisite** None**Prerequisite/Corequisite**

None

Note:

I will be seeking SUNY Gen Ed in Diversity: Equity, Inclusion, and Social Justice for this course next Fall. I did not see it listed in the menu above.

HI 4051 - Logic and Scientific Reasoning

Credits: 4

An introduction to scientific reasoning, including elementary logic, theory testing and decision-making. A practical course designed to help students read and interpret scientific findings, especially reports that appear in popular magazines and newspapers. More specific topics include probability, causal and statistical hypotheses, correlations, causation and sampling techniques. Although the course offers special benefits to students in the sciences and social sciences, no technical background is assumed.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 4062 - Making History

Credits: 4

Students will examine a variety of approaches to the study and writing of history. The course challenges the popular conceptions of history as a simple record of the past and of historians as the keepers of that record. The aim is to reveal the active role of the historian in the making of history and to show the uses of the past in the present and for the future.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 4210 - Special Topics

Credits: 4

This special topics course offers upper division courses in History that are offered only occasionally or on a one-time basis. These courses are designed for majors in History (Liberal Arts and Social Studies track) and will fulfill upper division requirements in that major.

Prerequisites

English proficiency required

HI 4305 - Islam and the Quran

Credits: 4

Through readings in the scripture, this course will introduce students to the character and content of the Quran, to gain an appreciation of its role in Muslim worship and community. In addition, the class will examine conceptions of revelation, prophethood, hidden or "mystical" truth, and basic theological questions in Islam. In examining modes of interpretation, students will gain insight into the development of schools of Islamic law and the differences between groups such as Sunni, Shia, and Sufi.

When Offered:

Alternate years.

HI 4306 - Golden Age of Islam

Credits: 4

This course focuses on the intellectual and cultural achievements of Islamic civilization, from Islam's emergence to Arabia in the 7th century through the Mongol invasions in the 13th century. Topics include: the development of Islamic law, science, arts, philosophy; the role of trade and the teachings of mysticism, and the rise of distinctive Persian and Turkish cultures in Islamic settings. The interactions of Islamic civilization with Byzantium and Europe, as well as Central Asia nomadic groups, will be discussed.

HI 4308 - History of the Modern Middle East

Credits: 4

This course is a survey of the major trends in the development of history, politics, and society in the Middle East from the nineteenth century on. We will cover this period with an emphasis on four inter-related themes: imperialism/colonialism, nationalism, war & conflict, and social history. We will think critically about the transformation of sovereignty in the Middle East from "Islamic" dynasties, to colonized mandates, to post-colonial nation-states. We will also be reading primary sources that provide opportunities to encounter the legal, ideological, and political shifts that re-made the Middle East in the modern age.

HI 4318 - Islamic Philosophy and Mysticism

Credits: 4

This course is an introduction to the history of Islamic philosophy and mysticism. It covers topics of human concern such as the ethical role of love and knowledge of the good life and human happiness. The course will compare Muslim and Western philosophers on topics such as "being," philosophical analysis, and "process metaphysics." The themes of the "clash of civilizations" vs. dialogue among cultures/philosophical issues will be explored.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 4395 - Philosophy from the 20th to the 21st Century

Credits: 4

This course covers highlights of philosophy in the twentieth and twenty first centuries. It begins with Modern European thought (British empiricism, continental rationalism) and its development in the nineteenth century (I. Kant and German Idealism); continues with early and later analytical philosophy; turns thereafter to existentialism, phenomenology, and pragmatism; and culminates in the philosophy of A. N. Whitehead. Readings include key selections from the works of Carnap, Sartre, Dewey, Heidegger, and the later works of Wittgenstein.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 4415 - Europe of the Dictators

Credits: 4

The course focuses on the rise of the totalitarian regimes (Fascism, Stalinism and Nazism) in the context of the development of modern Europe. It begins by tracing their roots in the nineteenth century; surveys their appearance and development in the early twentieth century, and concludes with the collapse of the Soviet bloc and the emergence of the new Europe in the 1980s and 1990s.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 4420 - Women and Witchcraft

Credits: 4

While the term "witchcraft" most commonly evokes images of the Salem witch trials and the early modern European witch persecutions, witchcraft has much earlier roots, in Hebrew and other ancient Near Eastern cultures and Celtic and Germanic religion and tradition. Although the witch hunts that plagued Europe for several centuries began in the late Middle Ages, it is clear that witchcraft accusations could be leveled at women - in some cases those who were powerful and/or influential - from a much earlier date. Despite the fact that both the sorcerer and the witch could be either male or female, there was a preponderance of women accused, tried and executed for witchcraft. This course will trace the history of witchcraft in Europe from late antiquity to the early modern period, with a focus on its association with women. As this course examines the history and development of witchcraft, it will incorporate case studies on women such as Queen Ælfthryth, Dame Alice Kyteler, Joan of Arc and Queen Anne Boleyn.

HI 4557 - Renaissance and Reformation in Europe

Credits: 4

The foundations of Modern Europe were laid in the two movements examined in this course. It begins with the revival of pagan classical culture in the commercial and urban milieu of Renaissance Italy, and traces the diffusion of the artistic and intellectual movement pioneered there to the rest of Europe. As Renaissance culture spread, it merged with existing traditions, and thereby contributed to the Reformation, a religious reform movement that transformed the Christian religion and convulsed Europe for more than a century. The course emphasizes the interconnections between Europe's socio-economic development, its political upheavals, and its dramatic cultural achievements.

When Offered:

Every other year.

HI 4600 - World Regional Geography

Credits: 4

This course focuses on the heightened connections between different parts of the world through a survey of the world's major regions. The course provides a description of the different environmental, economic, cultural, political and social aspects of world regions as well as an understanding of the differential effects of globalizaion on particular local and regional settings. An emphasis is given to the varying reagional environmental consequences of this interconnection.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 4632 - Japanese History through Literature

Credits: 4

From Samurai to Businessmen: a survey of Japanese history and culture from before the days of the Samurai warrior to the world of the modern business corporation. Special emphasis on aspects of Japanese culture that remain important today: the question of Japan as a country of cultural "imitators"; the relationship between the traditional importance of groups in Japanese society and Japan's enormous industrial success; and the significance of the Japanese emphasis on skills of art and violence-once so admired in Samurai warriors and still highly valued today.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 4650 - The History of African Enslavement

Credits: 4

The study of various forms of enslavement in Africa from precolonial times to the present. Topics include: domestic/ African slavery, "Oriental" and trans-Atlantic slave trade & human trafficking.

When Offered:

Periodically.

HI 4700 - Modern Global Environments

Credits: 4

This course will introduce the evolving mentalities about nature and the environment, which influenced human behavior and actions in the twentieth and twenty-first centuries. Specifically, it will look at the ways in which people, cultures, and their corresponding social, economic, and political organizations have attempted to secure energy. Energy is a broad term which we will explore as it pertains to food (the energy source powering human muscle) and biomass, fossil, and renewal fuels (for heat, mechanical, and electrical energy). The course aims to familiarize students with the fundamentals of studying history as an important basis for developing and improving writing skills, critical thinking, and research abilities.

HI 4800 - History of India

Credits: 4

Fat Maharajas atop bejeweled elephants, naked holy men sitting silently along the roadside, ragged children begging for scraps of food, maddened zealots attacking each other from caste hatred or religious fanaticism -these are the stark images that dominate American and Western ideas about India. But India's 5,000-year history offers much more. From the intricacies of an ancient Sanskrit-based culture and the grandeur of Mughal tombs to the vibrancy of modern Bollywood films and the contending ethnic/religious identities of post Independence India-India's history tells the story of how diverse populations wove together their different ways of life to create the multi-dimensional tapestry that is India today. This one semester course explores the vibrant diversity of India's past with an emphasis on its multiple legacies and the ways 20th and 21st century Indians have used these legacies to construct modern identities and a modern, democratic nation.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 4850 - Domesticity in the 19th and Early 20th Century

Credits: 4

"A place for everything and everything in its place." This trans-regional history course explores the spread of European, middle-class ideas about home and family life-global domesticity-throughout the 19th century world, with special focus on origins in England and development in and impact on America, India and Africa. What relationship should exist between a husband and a wife, how a mother should raise her children, even how kitchen spices should be arranged on a storeroom wall-all became issues for debate and contestation. We look at these debates and conflicts through domestic

manuals produced in these countries and through the life stories of people (mostly women) who wrote and/or read these materials.

HI 4900 - Modern China - a Study Abroad Course on Chinese Civilization

Credits: 4

Offered in conjunction with the faculty and staff of a university in China. Through lectures, trips, and everyday living experiences, this 4 week summer course will introduce students to all aspects of life in modern China-from its culture to its business community, from its political philosophy to the ideas of the men and women on its streets. Students will attend lectures and live at Wuyi University and work with Wuyi faculty and students. Day trips will allow students to explore cultural spots and cities in Guangdong Province and a special four day trip will take students to nearby Hong Kong and Macao.

When Offered:

For 4 weeks in May-June.

HI 4905 - Chinese Civilization

Credits: 4

This course investigates how China became "China" through an exploration of its history from the Neolithic period through the early years of the PRC. Through lecture, secondary scholarship, and primary source readings, we will discuss and analyze major social, political, and cultural developments, such as religious and philosophical changes, the impact of warfare and rebellion, governmental reforms, foreign relations, gender dynamics, and material innovations. This course pays particular attention to the ways major historical events shaped the everyday lives of those who lived through them-including women and members of minority populations.

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 4910 - Chinese Diasporas

Credits: 4

This transregional course examines the migration of Chinese people both within and outside China's borders from the early 1500s to the present. We will discuss why individuals and families moved away from the core areas of China to reside at the peripheries of its empire and across the world, including places like Taiwan, Southeast Asia, the United States, Latin America, Africa, and Europe. We will grapple with issues related to themes of law, race, class, labor, and identity as we read samples of historical scholarship in the form of book chapters and articles. Topics will include colonial/settler societies, servitude and human trafficking, exclusion, intermarriage, cultural hybridity, and "new migrants." You will engage in debate on questions about the utility and limitations of "diaspora" as a concept to define the experiences of Chinese migrants as well as the role of states/nations in promoting and discouraging the movement of people. Our course readings highlight gender as a meaningful category for understanding the history of Chinese migration as we collectively ask-is migration gendered?

When Offered:

Annually.

HI 5000 - Social Studies Senior Seminar

Credits: 4

This course is the required capping course for History majors completing the Social Studies Track and for Adolescence Education Social Studies majors completing the B.A. in History (Social Studies Track). It focuses on the issue of global human rights. Students define, research, and write a major research paper on some aspect of human rights.

When Offered:

Every semester.

HI 5900 - Senior Seminar

Credits: 4

Designed for students earning degrees in History (Liberal Arts Track), the Senior Seminar focuses on global human rights. Students define, research, and write a major research paper on an historical topic related to a human rights issue.

When Offered:

Every semester.

HI 5910 - Senior Research Project

Credits: 4

A research project required of Philosophy and Religion majors that can be structured in one of the following ways: 1) The student may enroll in HI 5910 at the same time as another upper-division Philosophy and Religion course and do the research project in conjunction with the course; OR 2) The student may enroll in HI 5910 and do the research project as a "stand-alone" undertaking in consultation with an adviser.

Prerequisites

Senior standing and permission of the course instructor (for option 1) or project adviser (for option 2)

Contract All Courses |